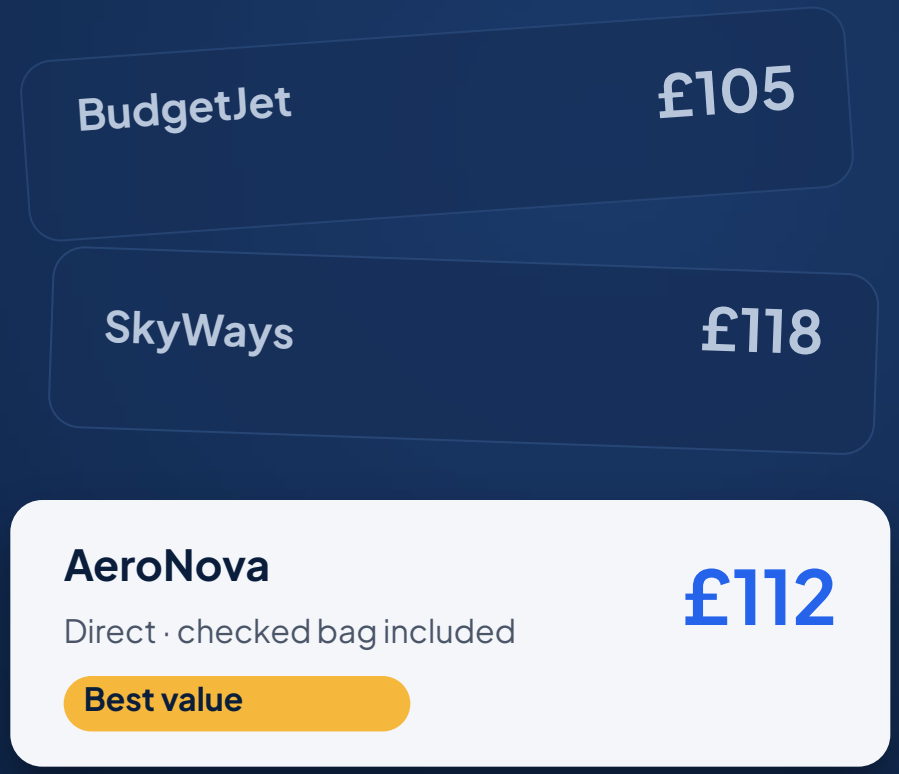
EDINBURGH AI HACKATHON · FLIP THE SCRIPT

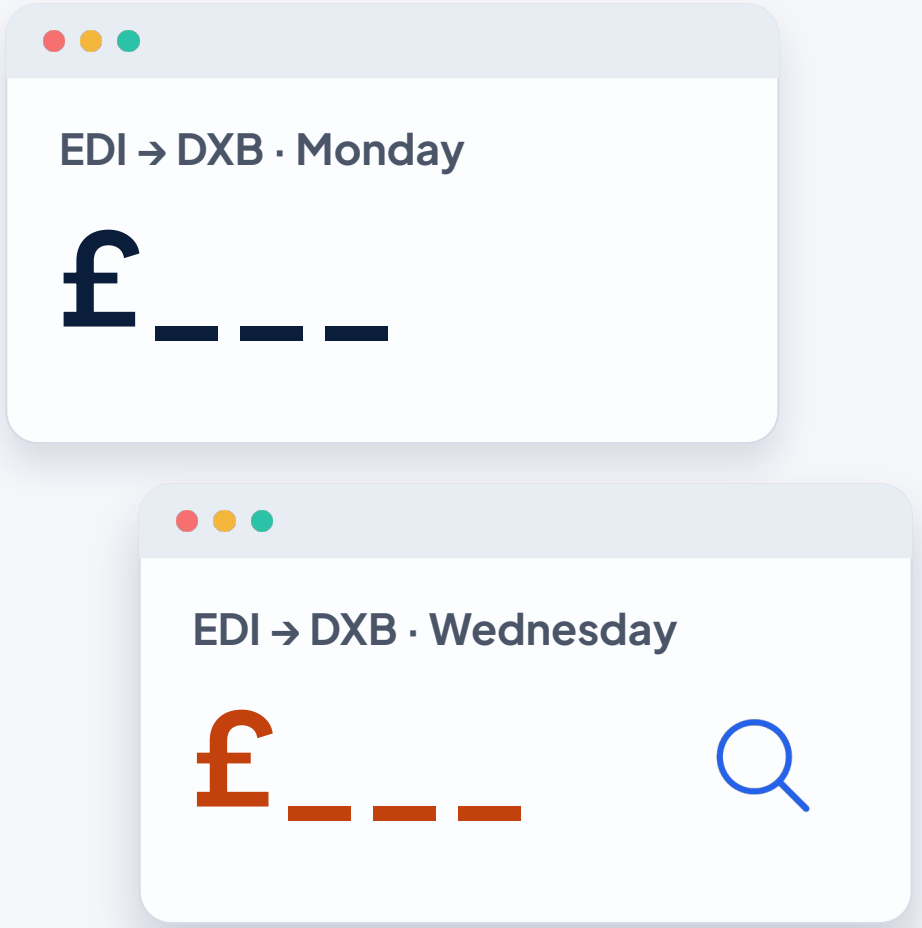
BidScanner

Tell airlines what you need. Let them bid for you.



THE PROBLEM

“Every time I fly home from Edinburgh to Dubai, I do the same thing. Open a flight search, see [£___], close it. Two days later it’s [£___]. I know exactly what I can afford.
Nobody ever asks.”



THE FLIP

You set the price. Airlines compete to win you.

Old rules

Airlines set the fare
Fixed before you even arrive

You do the chasing
More dates, routes and tabs

Cheapest headline wins
Even when bags matter more

BidScanner

You set the terms
Route, dates, budget, must-haves

Airlines bid for you
Adjusting price and extras

Best value wins
Not just the lowest price

Old assumption: **airlines set the price, and travellers take it or leave it.** The flip: **travellers set the price, and airlines compete to win them.**

WHY THIS FLIP WORKS

An empty seat is worth nothing once the plane leaves.

Seat flown empty

£0



Seat sold on BidScanner

£110

Airlines would rather sell that seat for £110 than fly it empty. They just had no way to find the traveller willing to pay it. **Now they do.**

LIVE DEMO

One request. Four steps.

01

Publish a request

Route, dates, bags and a maximum budget

02

AI airlines decide

Each agent has a strategy and explains its bid

03

Code checks every bid

Over budget? Rejected, with the reason shown

04

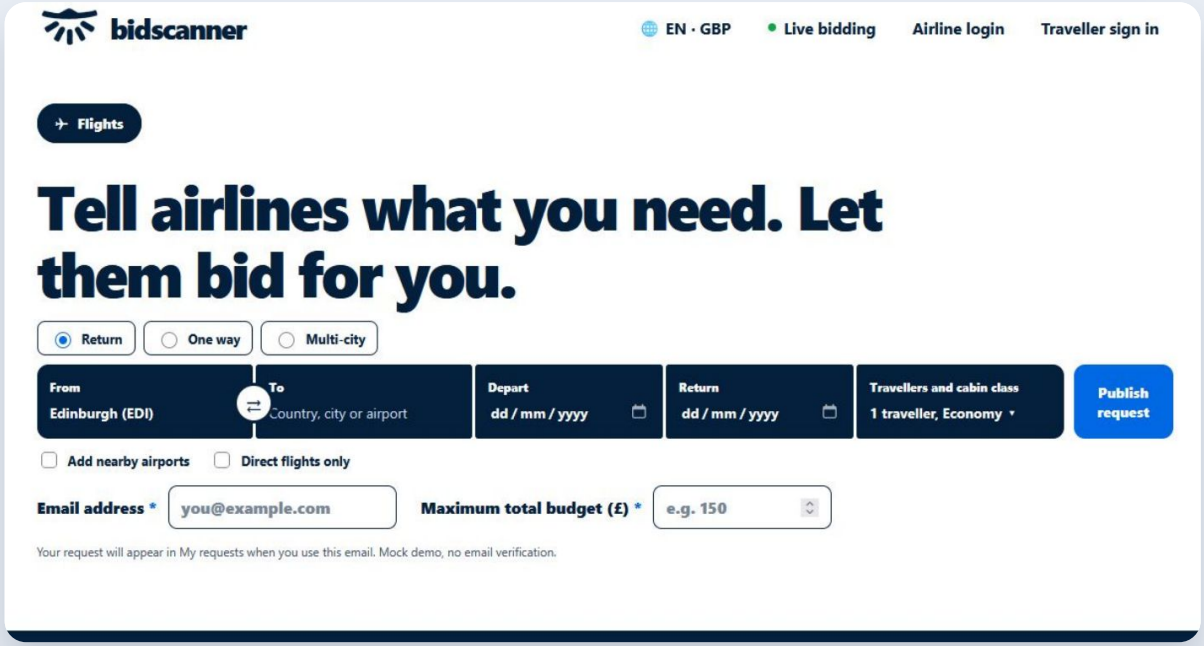
You pick the winner

Valid offers ranked by a value score

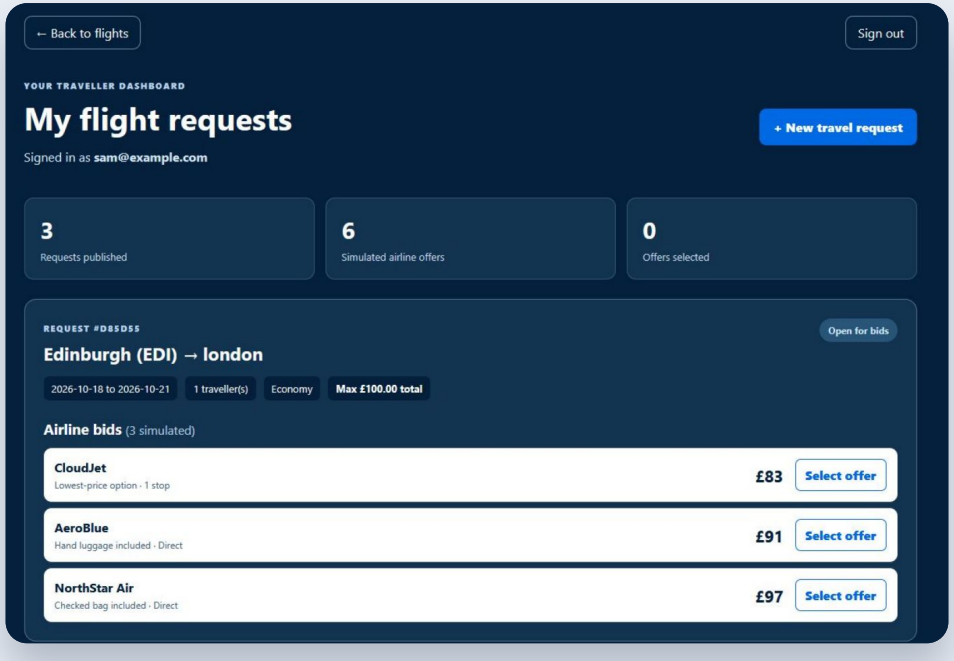
Every bid, from a person or an AI agent, goes through the same checks. No agent can bid past your budget.

THE TRAVELLER SIDE

Publish once. Watch the bids land.



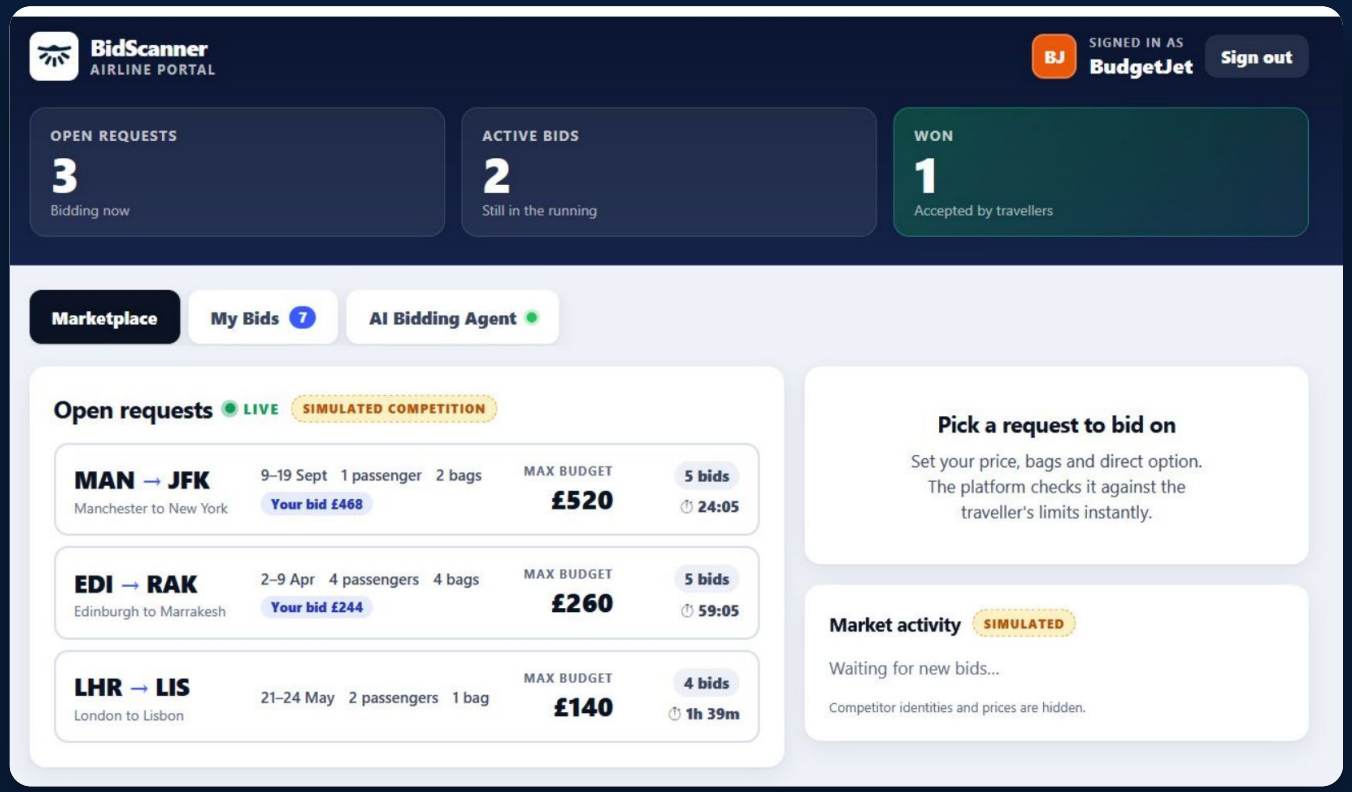
1 · Name your route, dates and maximum budget



2 · Airlines respond with competing offers

THE AIRLINE SIDE

Airlines get a live marketplace.



Live requests

Budgets, bid counts and countdowns

Rivals' prices hidden

Airlines see their rank, so they compete on value, not £1 undercuts

AI bidding agent

Aggressive, balanced or premium

HOW OFFERS ARE RANKED

“Best” is a score, not a sticker price.



Example: Edinburgh → Barcelona, budget £150, one traveller

BudgetJet · £105
Cheapest, but one stop and no bag

36 pts

AeroNova · £118
£13 more, but direct with a bag

66 pts

TECH STACK

AI decides how to bid. Code decides what's valid.

LLM AGENTS

Airline personas

Return a structured bid plus their reasoning

SPRING BOOT

Validation

Where the trust lives: one path for every bid

SPRING BOOT

Scoring

Weighted, explainable, deterministic

REACT

Live views

Traveller and airline, updating as bids arrive

Built with help from Claude for planning, scaffolding and code generation. We reviewed and tested everything ourselves.

BEING UPFRONT

What’s real, and what’s simulated.

Built and working

- Traveller request flow
- Airline portal and live bidding view
- Budget checks and rejections
- Weighted, explained ranking

Simulated for the demo

- Airlines, routes and seats
- Bookings: nothing is purchased
- Logins use demo accounts
- In-memory storage, fresh each run

KNOWING THE LIMITS

Where BidScanner breaks today.

Airlines have to opt in

A two-sided marketplace needs real airlines and their inventory first.

Bids take time

Great for planners. Not for a flight you need tonight.

Unrealistic budgets get no bids

£30 to Dubai gets silence. We'd need to suggest a realistic range.

AI agents could game it

Hidden prices and code-enforced rules help. Real use needs monitoring.

To make it real: live airline APIs, proper airline accounts, Postgres behind our existing repositories, and payments.

Skyscanner scans for flights.

BidScanner makes flights scan for you.

Thank you!